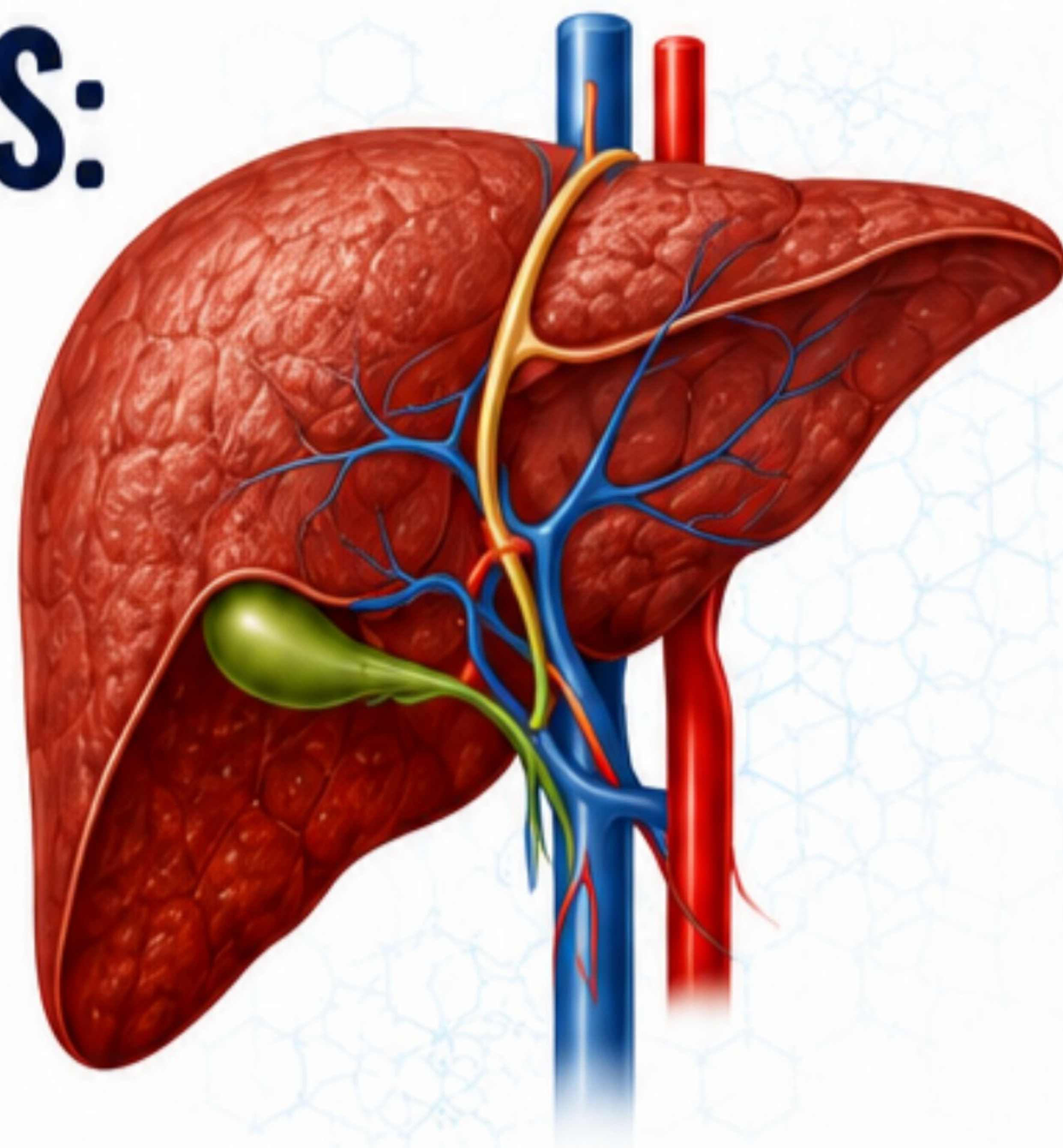


HEPATITIS AWARENESS: PROTECTING YOUR LIVER HEALTH

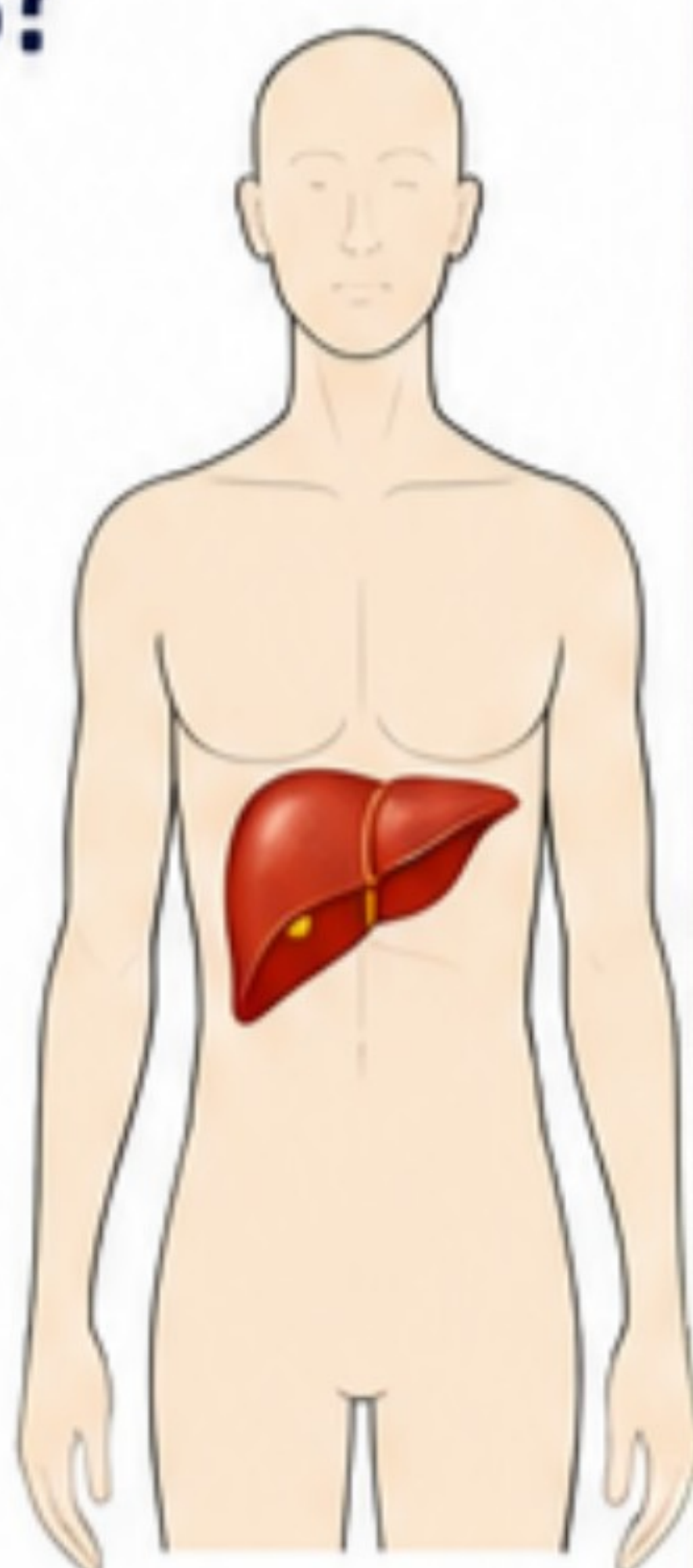
Hepatitis, defined as inflammation of the liver, presents a significant global health challenge (WHO) often caused by viral infections, though other factors can trigger the condition.



Before we go into the different types, let's first understand what hepatitis means.

1 WHAT IS HEPATITIS?

Hepatitis simply means inflammation of the liver. In a layman's understanding, it means the liver becomes inflamed or damaged. This can happen for different reasons. It can be caused by a viral infection, but viral infection is not the only cause.



Liver location
(Upper right quadrant
beneath the diaphragm)

2 THE LIVER: A VITAL ORGAN

The liver is the largest organ of the internal organ of the body, in fact, it's the second largest organ of the body after the skin. It's located at the upper right quadrant of the body beneath the diaphragm.

It helps in detoxification of harmful substances, protein synthesis, hormones production, metabolism and production of biochemical necessary for digestion.

Because of its various vital functions, the liver is very necessary for survival. So, damage to the liver is referred to as Hepatitis.

In addition to the Aforementioned causes of hepatitis, Other causes can include excessive alcohol intake, certain drugs or medicines, toxins, and autoimmune conditions.

When we talk about hepatitis, most people usually think about the viral types, and that's what we're going to focus on today.

“ Understanding hepatitis is the first step to prevention, early detection and better liver health. ”



DID YOU KNOW?

The liver performs over 500 vital functions that keep the body healthy every day.



Hepatitis can be prevented, treated and managed — knowledge saves lives.

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3 TYPES OF HEPATITIS

There are five major types of viral hepatitis:



HEPATITIS A



HEPATITIS B



HEPATITIS C



HEPATITIS D



HEPATITIS E

Each is caused by a different virus.



But before we talk about them one after another, there is another type I want us to know about, which is autoimmune hepatitis.



AUTOIMMUNE HEPATITIS

Autoimmune hepatitis is different from viral hepatitis.

This happens when the immune system mistakenly sees the liver cells as harmful and starts attacking them. So instead of protecting the body, the immune system starts damaging the liver.



Now let's go back to the five major types of viral hepatitis.

4 HEPATITIS A

Hepatitis A is caused by the hepatitis A virus.

It is mainly transmitted through contaminated food or water. So, poor sanitation and poor hygiene can increase the risk of getting hepatitis A.

Hepatitis A is usually an acute infection, meaning it does not normally become a long-term infection.

There is also a vaccine that can prevent hepatitis A.

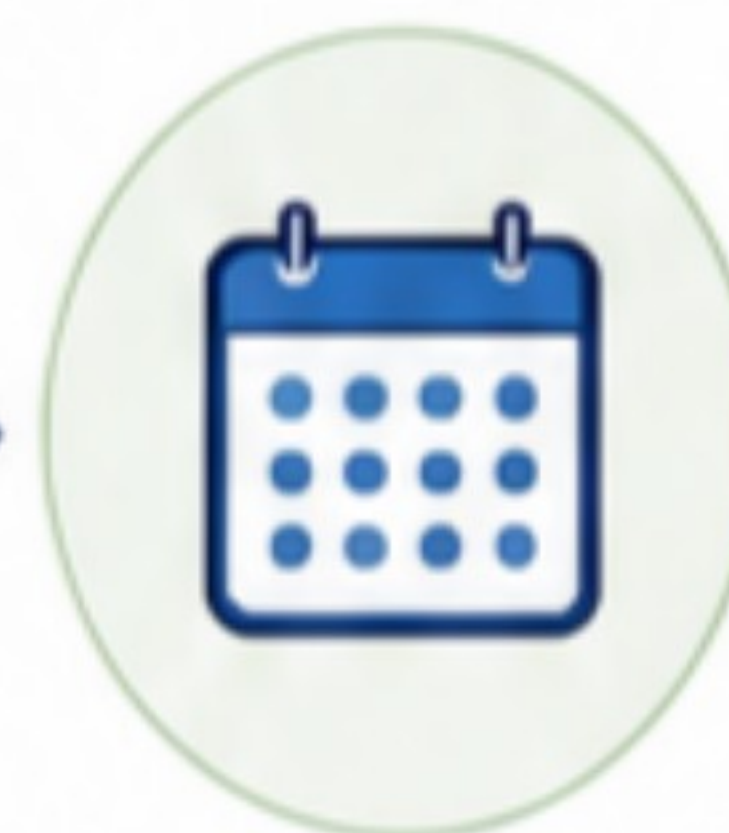
HEPATITIS A AT A GLANCE



Food & Water



Infection



Usually Acute



Vaccine
Available



“Hepatitis A is preventable. Good hygiene, safe food and clean water go a long way in protecting you.”



PROTECT YOURSELF
Practice good hygiene, ensure safe food and water, and get vaccinated.



5 HEPATITIS B

Hepatitis B is caused by the hepatitis B virus.

It can be transmitted through infected blood and other body fluids. It can also be transmitted through sexual contact and from an infected mother to her baby during childbirth.

One important thing about hepatitis B is that it can become chronic, meaning it can remain in the body for a long period of time.

Chronic hepatitis B can cause serious liver problems, including liver cirrhosis and liver cancer.

But the good thing is that there is a vaccine for hepatitis B, and it can help prevent the infection.

HOW HEPATITIS B IS TRANSMITTED



Infected Blood
and Body Fluids



Sexual
Contact



Mother to Baby
During Childbirth



WHY HEPATITIS B MATTERS

- ✓ Can become a chronic infection.
- ✓ Can lead to serious liver problems such as liver cirrhosis and liver cancer.
- ✓ A vaccine is available and can prevent hepatitis B infection.

PROTECT YOURSELF



Get vaccinated
against
hepatitis B.



Avoid contact
with infected
blood and
body fluids.



Practise safe
sex.



Ensure proper
medical care
during pregnancy
and childbirth.

6 HEPATITIS C

Hepatitis C is caused by the hepatitis C virus.

It is mainly transmitted through infected blood. For example, sharing contaminated needles or using unsafe equipment that comes into contact with blood can spread it.

Sexual transmission can also happen, although blood exposure is the major route.

There is currently no vaccine for hepatitis C, but unlike what many people may think, hepatitis C can often be cured with proper antiviral treatment.

It can also become chronic and cause serious liver damage if it is not treated.

IMPORTANT TO KNOW

NO VACCINE
≠
NO CURE

Hepatitis C can
often be cured
with proper
antiviral
treatment.



7 HEPATITIS D

Then we have hepatitis D, which is caused by the hepatitis D virus.

Hepatitis D is a little different because it only occurs in people who have hepatitis B infection.

A person can get hepatitis B and D at the same time, or someone who already has hepatitis B can later become infected with hepatitis D.

It can also be transmitted through infected blood and body fluids.

One important thing to remember is that the hepatitis B vaccine can prevent hepatitis D indirectly, because without hepatitis B, hepatitis D cannot establish infection.

HOW IT WORKS



Hepatitis B
vaccine



Prevents
Hepatitis B



Indirectly
prevents
Hepatitis D



The vaccine does
not cure hepatitis B
or hepatitis D.

“

While the Hepatitis B vaccine helps to prevent Hepatitis D, it cannot cure either of the viruses and it's the same for other types of hepatitis.

”

WHY THIS MATTERS

Hepatitis B, C and D can lead to serious liver disease, but knowledge, prevention and early action can save lives. Get informed. Get tested. Get vaccinated where available. Protect yourself and those you love.



GET
TESTED



GET
VACCINATED



STAY
PROTECTED



PROTECT YOUR
COMMUNITY

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9 HEPATITIS E

Finally, we have hepatitis E, which is caused by the hepatitis E virus.

Hepatitis E is mainly transmitted through contaminated water and food.

It is usually an acute infection and, in most healthy people, the body is able to clear the infection.

However, hepatitis E can be particularly serious in pregnant women, especially during later pregnancy.

There is a hepatitis E vaccine, but it is not widely available as part of routine vaccination programmes in many countries.

HOW HEPATITIS E IS TRANSMITTED



Contaminated
Water



Contaminated
Food

DID YOU KNOW?



Although a hepatitis E vaccine exists, it is not widely available as part of routine vaccination programmes in many countries.

10 WHY SHOULD WE BE CONCERNED?

Hepatitis is something we should take seriously because some types, especially hepatitis B and C, can remain in the body for years without obvious symptoms.

A person may look completely fine and still have the infection.

If chronic hepatitis is not detected and managed, it can gradually damage the liver and may lead to liver cirrhosis (scarring of the liver) or liver cancer.

So this is not something we should ignore.

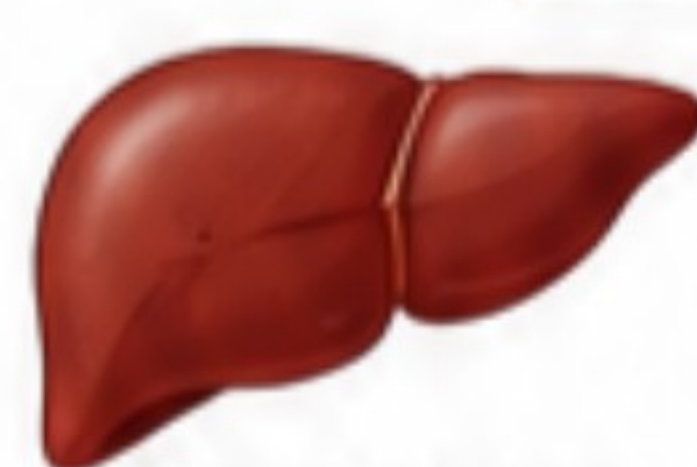


GLOBAL HEALTH FACT



According to the World Health Organization, over 300 million people are living with hepatitis, and over 250 million are living with hepatitis B. Viral hepatitis remains a major public health problem.

THE PROGRESSION OF LIVER DISEASE



Chronic Liver
Disease



Cirrhosis
(Scarring of the liver)



Liver Cancer

11 COMMON SYMPTOMS

While chronic cases can stay completely hidden for decades, acute infections or advanced liver damage may present with:



Yellowing of the skin and eyes
(Jaundice)



Dark, tea-coloured urine



Pale, clay-coloured stools



Extreme, unexplained fatigue
and weakness



Persistent nausea, loss of appetite,
or abdominal pain

12 WHAT CAN WE DO?

We can reduce our risk by:



Getting vaccinated
against hepatitis B.



Practising good
hygiene and
sanitation.



Avoiding contact
with infected
blood.



Not sharing
needles or sharp
instruments.



Ensuring medical
and cosmetic
equipment is
properly sterilised.



Practising
safer sex.



Getting tested
when
appropriate.



Seeking medical
attention instead of
simply assuming
that symptoms will
disappear.

13 FINAL TAKE-HOME MESSAGE

**“DON'T WAIT
UNTIL YOU
FEEL SICK.”**

And most importantly, don't wait until you feel sick before you take your health seriously.

Some people living with hepatitis may not have obvious symptoms for a long time.

So, know your status, protect yourself, and encourage the people around you to do the same.



REMEMBER

- ✓ Hepatitis is preventable.
- ✓ Early detection saves lives.
- ✓ Treatment works. Support is available.



Together, we can build healthier people,
stronger communities, and a better tomorrow.